



Curbside

Non-Confidential Executive Summary

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Business Summary

Started in 2026, Curbside is building a used-car buying platform that guides people through the entire private-party purchase, from comparing vehicles and understanding risks to negotiating, arranging inspections, and connecting with financing and secure transaction services. Our mission is to make this process clearer and more accessible for people who depend on reliable transportation.

Our first product is a Chrome extension that compares a vehicle's asking price directly against other Facebook Marketplace listings. Buyers see how the car compares with alternatives in the marketplace where they are shopping. Curbside combines those comparisons with vehicle risk indicators and negotiation guidance in an explained score out of 100, helping buyers decide which vehicles deserve further attention.

Our strategy is to grow from this evaluation product into a connected buying experience. We plan to add service-provider partnerships and offer our technology through software subscriptions and licensing to credit unions and automotive platforms. Our objectives are to validate consumer value, connect useful purchase services, and establish a path to recurring business revenue.

Customer Problem

Private-party used-car buyers face a major financial decision with incomplete information and limited support. Listings can omit important details, asking prices are difficult to compare, and buyers often lack the experience to recognize warning signs or negotiate effectively. A seemingly affordable vehicle can become an expensive mistake.

The problem continues after a promising vehicle is found. Buyers must piece together pricing research, vehicle history, inspections, financing, and purchase logistics across separate services. Students, first-time buyers, and budget-conscious households may have limited time, money, or experience to manage that process.

Curbside aims to turn scattered information into clear, actionable guidance throughout the purchase. Consumers would pay for faster screening, understandable risk explanations, and help deciding what to do next. Free evaluations allow them to experience the value before purchasing additional checks or a shopping-period subscription.

Willingness to pay will be tested through completed purchases, interviews, and repeat use. For future business customers, the proposed value is providing useful buying support within an existing member or customer relationship. Paid pilots will test that proposition separately from consumer demand.

Product/Services

Curbside evaluates a Facebook Marketplace vehicle using comparable asking prices from other Facebook Marketplace listings. This gives buyers pricing context grounded in vehicles offered on the same platform, with adjustments for relevant characteristics such as mileage and trim. The results combine price comparisons, risk indicators, and negotiation guidance. Saved evaluations support a shortlist. Asking prices are not completed sale prices, and an evaluation does not replace an inspection.

Our planned platform would carry this guidance through the purchase. A buyer could compare vehicles, prepare questions for the seller, arrange an inspection through a provider, and connect with financing and secure transaction services. These capabilities are future development objectives; provider relationships have not been confirmed.

We also intend to offer evaluation and buying tools to credit unions and automotive platforms through subscriptions, licensing, and integrations. A credit union could provide members with vehicle research support alongside its financing process. An automotive platform could incorporate Curbside guidance into its existing customer experience.

The implemented foundation includes capture, evaluation, accounts, saved results, and payment integration code. An internal review reported 15.3% median absolute percentage error across 4,133 held-out asking-price predictions. Overall verdict agreement was 38% across 72 labels from one reviewer. These are preliminary internal results; broader independent validation remains necessary. [1]

Our intellectual property position centers on original software, evaluation methods, and proprietary know-how. [Confirm copyright ownership, trademark or patent status, and third-party licensing.] Future defensibility would also depend on permitted outcome feedback and partner integrations.

Operating priorities include platform permissions, privacy, data rights, and clear responsibility for partner services. Future financing and transaction arrangements require specialist review before implementation. Referral compensation should be disclosed and separated from evaluation scores. No measured environmental benefit is claimed.

Target Market

Curbside initially targets U.S. private-party buyers using Facebook Marketplace on desktop Chrome. Cox Automotive's December 2025 forecast projected 38.3 million U.S. used-vehicle sales in 2026, down 0.9% from 2025. This is a broad industry benchmark, not a count of eligible users. [2]

An illustrative reachable segment of 5% of that volume would equal 1.915 million shopping episodes; the percentage requires validation. The broader opportunity includes credit unions and automotive platforms buying software, plus services used during a purchase. Institutional contract values and partner revenue potential will be sized through pilot discussions, rather than treated as established demand.

Customers

Our priority consumers are students, first-time buyers, and budget-conscious households actively searching for reliable transportation. They need understandable comparisons, practical questions, and help coordinating the steps between finding a vehicle and completing a purchase.

Future business customers are credit unions seeking member-facing buying tools and automotive platforms seeking integrated evaluation and purchase guidance. Inspection, financing, and transaction providers are potential service partners. These groups have different needs and will be validated through separate interviews and pilots.

Sales/Marketing Strategy

Initial distribution will use the Chrome Web Store and Curbside website. Demonstrations will lead with the core benefit: compare a car’s asking price directly with other Facebook Marketplace listings while shopping. Educational content, university networks, automotive communities, and referrals will connect that comparison to a real purchase decision. Paid acquisition will expand after conversion and acquisition costs justify it.

Three planning cases link marketing activity to annual consumer sales. Conservative assumes slower organic reach and weak conversion; realistic assumes steady educational content, campus outreach, and referrals; optimistic assumes stronger referrals and successful community distribution. These are testable assumptions, not measured conversion rates or guaranteed outcomes.

Qualified visits are website or store visits from prospective buyers; activation means completing a first evaluation. Paying customers equal activated shoppers multiplied by paid conversion. Counts assume deduplicated shoppers within each year. Figures below are ordered 2026 / 2027 / 2028; 2026 is a launch-year total, not an annualized run rate.

Annual funnel	Conservative	Realistic	Optimistic
Qualified visits	20,000 / 40,000 / 80,000	50,000 / 100,000 / 200,000	80,000 / 200,000 / 400,000
Activation rate	10%	20%	25%
Activated shoppers	2,000 / 4,000 / 8,000	10,000 / 20,000 / 40,000	20,000 / 50,000 / 100,000
Paid conversion	3%	5%	8%
Paying customers	60 / 120 / 240	500 / 1,000 / 2,000	1,600 / 4,000 / 8,000
Marketing budget \$	300 / 600 / 1,200	1,500 / 3,000 / 6,000	3,000 / 8,000 / 16,000

Marketing budgets cover small content, outreach, and paid tests; founder outreach time is unpaid. The visits depend mainly on organic distribution, not purchased clicks. Review activation, conversion, and acquisition cost monthly before expanding spend. The optimistic case requires repeatable distribution before scaling.

In parallel, we will pursue inspection-provider and institutional pilots. No signed distribution agreements or partner-generated consumer traffic are assumed; business sales will be validated separately.

Business Model

The first revenue stream is consumer freemium access. Current pricing provides ten free checks, ten additional checks for \$7.99, twenty for \$11.99, or unlimited evaluations for \$16.99 per month. Paid packs do not expire. This accommodates a concentrated car-shopping period without assuming a year-long consumer subscription. [6]

The second planned stream is partnership revenue from inspection, financing, and secure transaction services, subject to appropriate agreements and review. The third is recurring software subscriptions and licensing to credit unions and automotive platforms. Business pricing will reflect usage, integration, support, and demonstrated value.

Current revenue, monthly burn, and capital received: [confirm actual amounts and sources, or none]. The realistic case budgets \$6,975, \$11,550, and \$20,700 in annual spending for 2026–2028. It produces operating results of negative \$975, positive \$450, and positive \$3,300. These figures exclude founder compensation and institutional development; the detailed cases below show the impact of weaker or stronger consumer adoption.

Competitors

Kelley Blue Book provides vehicle valuations, including private-party values. CarGurus offers valuation tools and deal ratings. CARFAX provides vehicle-history reports. These established brands address important parts of a buyer's research and bring recognition and data resources that Curbside must respect. [3–5]

Direct competitors also include Marketplace-focused extensions. CarScout advertises comparable-listing searches and ranked alternatives from a Marketplace vehicle page. [7] Curbside will compete through the usefulness of its Marketplace comparisons, risk explanations, and negotiation guidance. Manual research and independent mechanics remain substitutes or complements.

Free research tools create a meaningful price hurdle. Curbside's paid consumer offer, currently \$7.99 to \$16.99, must demonstrate useful listing-specific guidance and convenience. Our proposed market position is a connected buying experience: helping a customer interpret a listing and then take practical steps toward purchase.

Our intended strength is continuity across decisions that buyers currently coordinate themselves. The current extension provides an accessible entry point; planned services would extend support through inspection, financing, and completion. We do not claim superior valuation accuracy or vehicle-history coverage without supporting evidence.

Competitor shares of this specific private-party buying-support market are not established in the available evidence. We therefore do not assign unsupported percentages. Pilot research will compare usability, customer trust, and willingness to pay against the tools buyers already use.

Competitive Advantage

Curbside's core strength is direct price comparison across Facebook Marketplace vehicle listings, combined with explanations that help buyers act. The benchmark comes from other listings in the same marketplace where the buyer is choosing a car. Our broader vision builds on that context to guide inspection, financing, and purchase steps, carrying useful vehicle information through the buying process.

The intended long-term advantage has three sources: better guidance informed by permitted buyer feedback, integrations that connect relevant services, and distribution through trusted organizations. For example, an inspection outcome could inform future evaluation improvements, while a credit union could introduce the tools to members already considering a vehicle purchase.

These advantages remain to be developed. The current feature set is reproducible, and no exclusive network or defensible data advantage is claimed. Sustainable differentiation will depend on reliable results, useful integrations, strong relationships, and customer trust. Partner compensation must not determine the evaluation score.

Management Team

[Founder name, degree program, relevant experience, and accomplishments.] Academic advisors: [names or none]. External advisors: [names or none]. The team has developed the initial evaluation product and will build on that foundation through customer research and partner pilots.

The venture needs capabilities in software development, automotive evaluation, buyer research, partnerships, and business sales. Early gaps can be addressed with advisors and targeted specialist engagements. Institutional deployment will add security, integration, and support requirements. [Identify current strengths and priority hires.]

We will use customer interviews, independent evaluation reviews, and pilot feedback to guide product and commercial decisions. This keeps the team responsive to evidence as the business grows from individual evaluations into purchase support and institutional software.

Goals

At the Hurricane Pitch Competition, Curbside seeks [confirm funding amount] in early funding, pilot customers, advisors, and introductions to inspection providers, credit unions, and automotive platforms. These relationships would help validate both the consumer product and the broader buying-platform opportunity.

Proposed milestones include 20 buyer interviews and a 25-person pilot within 30 days; initial paid purchases and ten prospective partner interviews within 90 days; and a defined service-provider or institutional pilot within six months. Launch-year paying-customer targets are 60 conservative, 500 realistic, and 1,600 optimistic, subject to the remaining 2026 launch window.

An illustrative \$10,000 award would support \$3,000 of evaluation reliability work, \$2,500 of customer research and acquisition, \$2,500 of pilot development, and \$2,000 of specialist review and contingency. The funding request and allocations require founder confirmation.

Financials (\$ US)

Curbside began in 2026. The following consumer projections use the sales funnel above for launch year 2026 and calendar years 2027–2028. All figures are illustrative planning assumptions; the realistic case is a working base case, not a validated forecast. Replace 2026 assumptions with year-to-date actuals plus the remaining-period forecast before submission.

Revenue equals annual paying customers × \$12 average total spend per payer, with no assumed recurring retention. Variable costs allow \$0.15 per activated shopper for evaluations and \$0.75 per payer for payment costs. These allowances cover free use and must be tested against actual usage. Fixed costs cover basic hosting, software, administration, and limited support.

Conservative

Financials (\$ US)	2026	2027	2028
Consumer revenue	720	1,440	2,880
Marketing	300	600	1,200
Variable service costs	345	690	1,380
Fixed operating costs	1,800	2,400	3,600
Total expenditures	2,445	3,690	6,180
Operating result	(1,725)	(2,250)	(3,300)

Realistic

Financials (\$ US)	2026	2027	2028
Consumer revenue	6,000	12,000	24,000
Marketing	1,500	3,000	6,000
Variable service costs	1,875	3,750	7,500
Fixed operating costs	3,600	4,800	7,200
Total expenditures	6,975	11,550	20,700
Operating result	(975)	450	3,300

Optimistic

Financials (\$ US)	2026	2027	2028
Consumer revenue	19,200	48,000	96,000
Marketing	3,000	8,000	16,000
Variable service costs	4,200	10,500	21,000
Fixed operating costs	6,000	12,000	24,000
Total expenditures	13,200	30,500	61,000
Operating result	6,000	17,500	35,000

Operating results exclude founder salaries, taxes, financing, capital purchases, and institutional development. No award, referral, or licensing revenue is included. Positive results therefore do not establish full business profitability. The conservative case needs \$10,275 to cover cumulative modeled losses through 2028, before contingency or excluded costs.

[1] Internal calibration review, docs/calibration-pass-1.md. [2] Cox Automotive, December 2025, 2026 Forecasts. [3] kbb.com/whats-my-car-worth/ [4] cargurus.com/research/car-valuation [5] carfax.com/vehicle-history-reports/ [6] Curbside pricing configuration. Sources reviewed September 29, 2026. [7] CarScout, Chrome Web Store: chromewebstore.google.com/detail/andcdhiiobnhnfnkfodhhghcjkdal (accessed September 30, 2026).